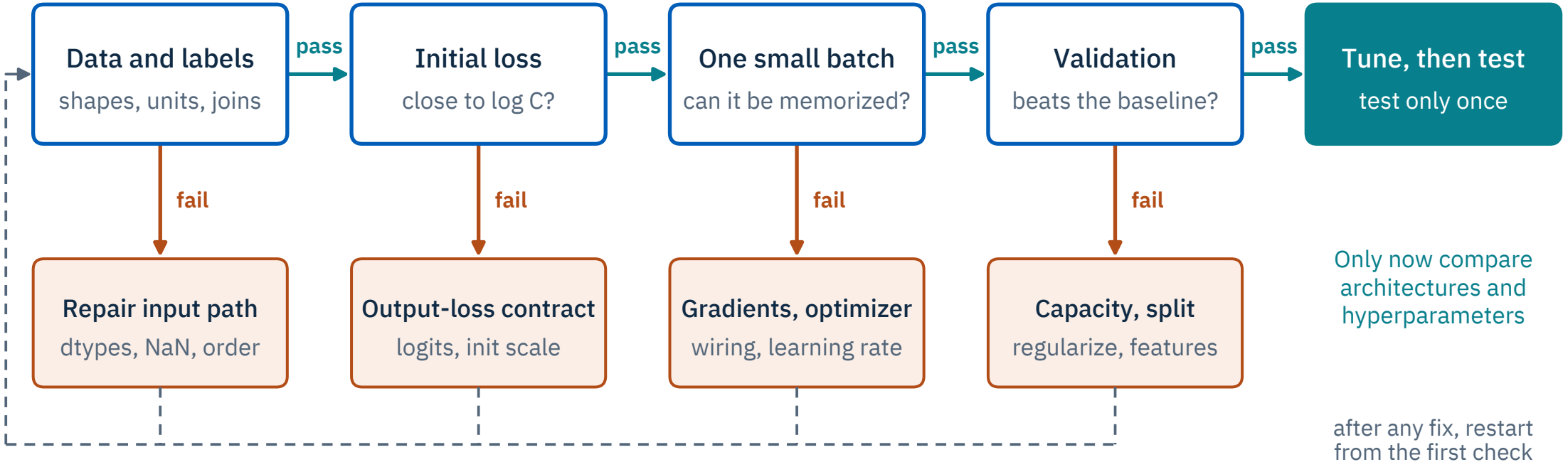
Data and labels
shapes, units, joins
pass
Initial loss
close to log C?
pass
One small batch
can it be memorized?
pass
Validation
beats the baseline?
pass
Tune, then test
test only once
fail
fail
fail
fail
Repair input path
dtypes, NaN, order
Output-loss contract
logits, init scale
Gradients, optimizer
wiring, learning rate
Capacity, split
regularize, features
Only now compare architectures and hyperparameters
after any fix, restart from the first check